

PREMIUM

Refusal Decision Guide

Review rights, reapplying, and what actually changes the outcome

Understand your options after a refusal

Outcome	What it means	What you can do
Refusal	The case officer wasn't satisfied you met the requirements - most commonly, the Genuine Temporary Entrant test or financial evidence.	Independent merits review is generally not available for a refused Tourist stream application - check your refusal letter for whether any review right applies to your specific case.
Reapplication	A new application, assessed fresh.	The most common and usually most effective path - but only if something material has actually changed or the weak point is now properly addressed.

Read your refusal letter closely

It states the specific reason(s) the case officer wasn't satisfied, and confirms whether any review right applies to your case. Address that reason directly in any reapplication - don't guess.

If you plan to reapply: what actually helps

- Address the specific reason given in the refusal letter, not just the application in general
- Strengthen whichever element was weak - clearer financial evidence, a more specific itinerary, better-documented ties at home
- If financial evidence was the issue, build a longer, more consistent statement history rather than a single larger deposit
- Consider a brief cover letter explaining what's changed since the refusal (see the Cover Letter templates, Complete tier)

What not to do

- Don't reapply immediately with an unchanged application
- Don't omit a previous refusal or visa cancellation on a later application, from Australia or elsewhere

- Don't submit materially false information to work around a previous refusal - this can lead to a longer-term exclusion from future applications

When to seek professional advice

Consider consulting a Registered Migration Agent (RMA) if you've been refused multiple times despite genuinely strengthening your case, or if your case involves more complex immigration history.